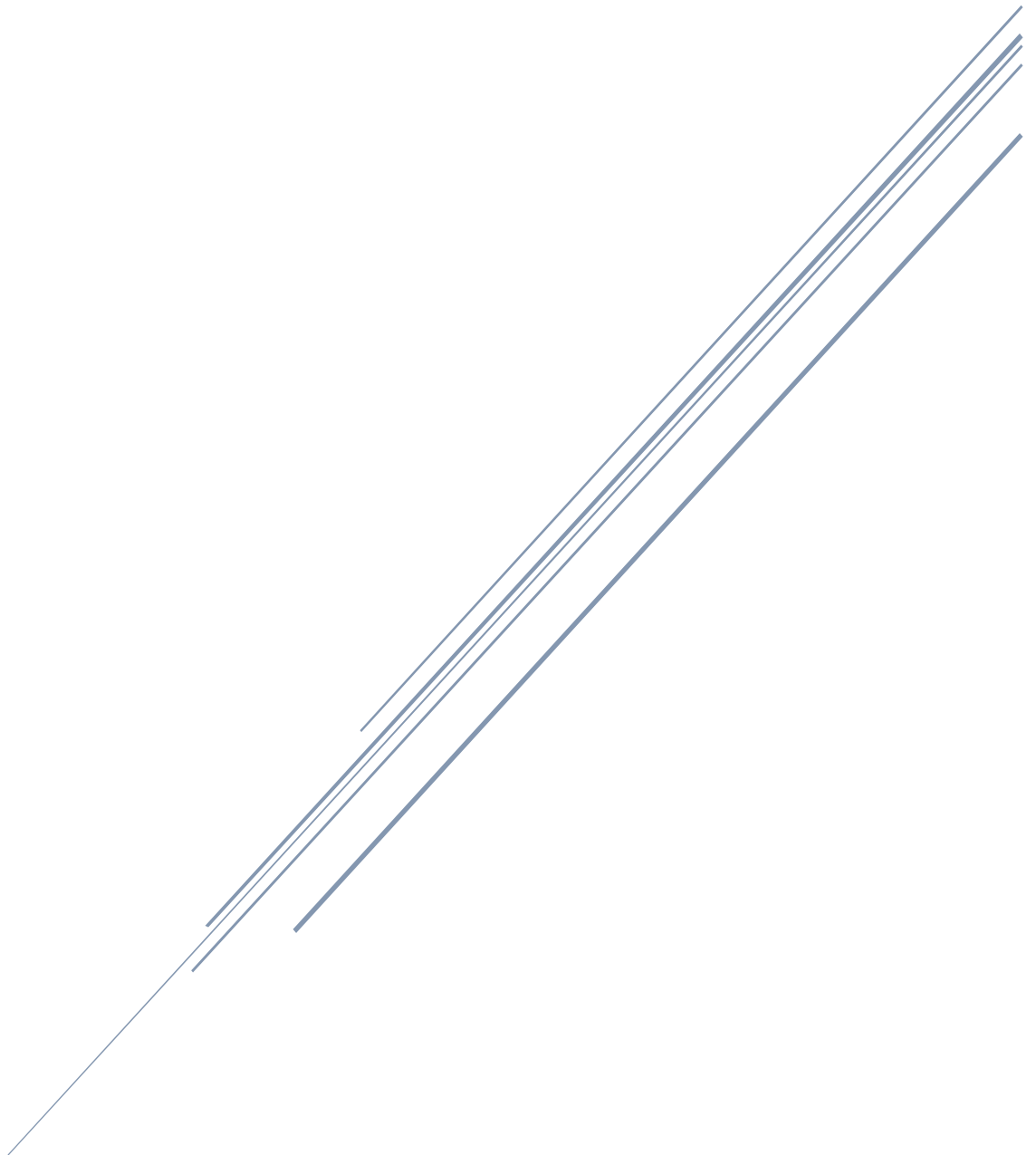


UX Report

By Beatrice Marro



Fontys University of Applied Sciences
Software S3

Contents

Introduction	2
Hofstede's UX Principle.....	2
1. Visibility of System Status	2
2. Match between system and the real world.....	3
3. User control and freedom.....	3
4. Error Prevention.....	4
5. Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors	4
6. Consistency and Standards	5
7. Recognition rather than recall	6
8. Flexibility and Efficiency of use	7
9. Aesthetic and Minimal Design	7
10. Help and Documentation.....	9
Feedback for UX.....	10
Conclusion.....	13

Introduction

User Experience is a very important concept which should be considered by developers and designers when developing an application. UX is important as it enables users to use software more easily, making them more satisfied with the use of the product, which in a business point of view, can lead to a positive impact, such as repeat purchases, or increased use of the application.

A UX Report is used to document the usability aspects of an application, this is helpful to make a user-friendly application by adhering to various UX principles. In addition to this, a UX report is a document which may continue to be constantly updated, in this way the UX is gradually updated to match user requirements.

Hofstede's UX Principle

1. Visibility of System Status

Use of loading screens throughout the web application for loading content, the same loading screen is used when loading large amount of content, such as a full article, when loading smaller amount of data, such as whether an article is in the user's favourites list, is loaded using a smaller and different loading screen, which is only displayed if an account of type used is logged in.

Regular Loader:



Mini Loader:



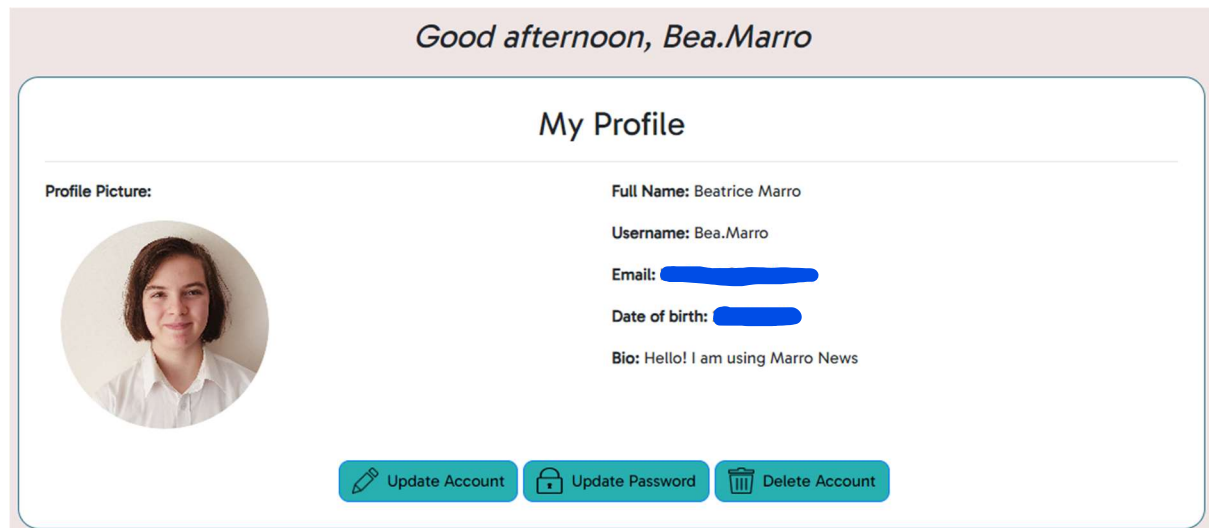
In addition to this, in the Articles page in which a journalist can view the journalists that they have created. They can also clearly view the approval status of the article, to see if the status of the article is Approved, Pending or Disapproved.

Italian influencer Chiara Ferragni sorry for hospital pandoro claim	View Article	2023-12-30	Breaking News	Approved		
January transfer window: Who could be on the move?	View Article	2024-01-12	Health Wellness	Disapproved		
Artemis: Nasa delays crewed return to the Moon	View Article	2024-01-12	Business Economics	Pending		

2. Match between system and the real world

The use of icons whose meaning of action is like that of the real-world can help users to familiarize themselves with the application. Examples of where I use these in my application are the following:

- ✓ Use of action buttons which represent real-life objects, using an icon with a trash bin for deleting and an icon with a pencil for editing items.



- ✓ Use of a magnifying glass icon in search bar



- ✓ Use of colourful button when approving an article, this gives 2 options, one which is a checkmark (green) and the other which is a cross (red).



3. User control and freedom

Some Undo and Redo features are supported by most modern browsers, so if a user wishes to undo or redo an action in a text field of the app, this can be achieved by using keyboard shortcuts, thus using Ctrl + Z for undo and Ctrl + Y for redo.

Regarding the navigation aspect for the application related to being able to go forth and back in the application, this is also already implemented by the browser, as the browsers consist of buttons to

go back and forth in the pages of the web application, due to this, I have not added any extra buttons for these navigation purposes.

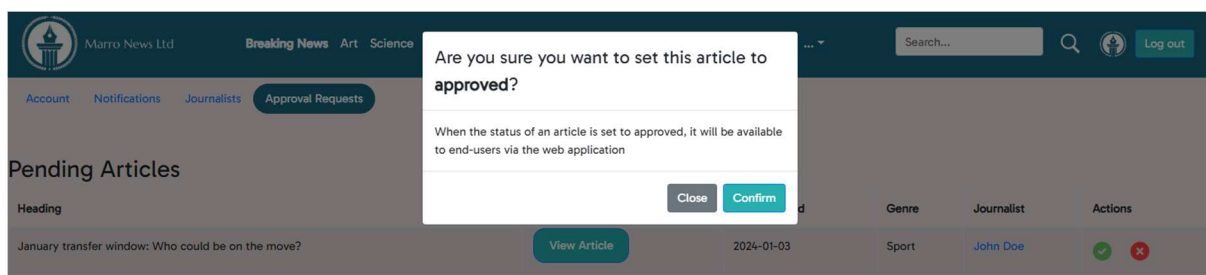


I have added clear “exit” buttons, in case the user does not wish to proceed with an action, which is shown very clearly by a large red cross button in the top-right corner, or in different cases, such as the logout where it makes sense to have just 2 options, this is displayed a secondary close button.

A form titled "Update Password" with a red close button (X) in the top right corner. It contains two input fields: "New Password*" and "Confirm New Password*". Below the fields is a teal "Update" button.A confirmation dialog box titled "Are you sure you want to log out?". It has two buttons at the bottom: a gray "Cancel" button and a teal "Log Out" button.

4. Error Prevention

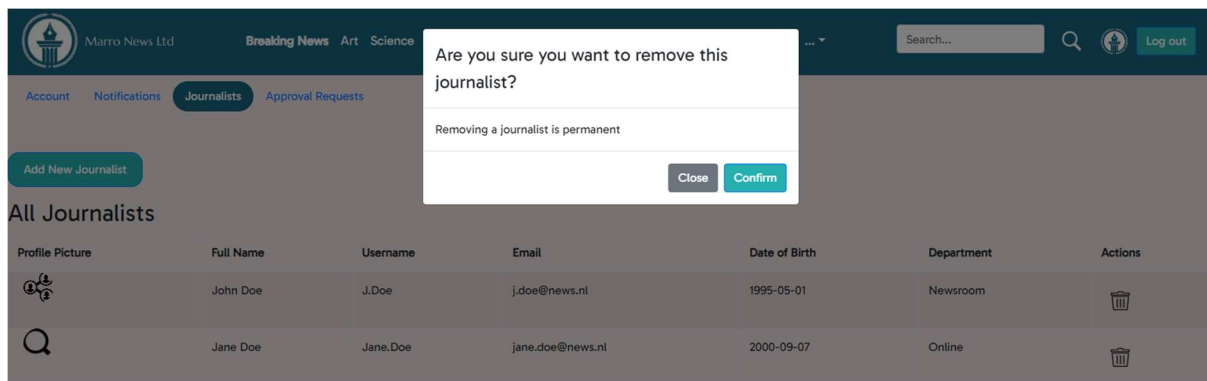
For any sensitive actions, such as changing the acceptance status of an article, a popup is displayed, which alerts and asks the user for confirmation when changing the status of an article, to ensure that the status is not accidentally changed, or changed to the incorrect status by the admin.



5. Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors

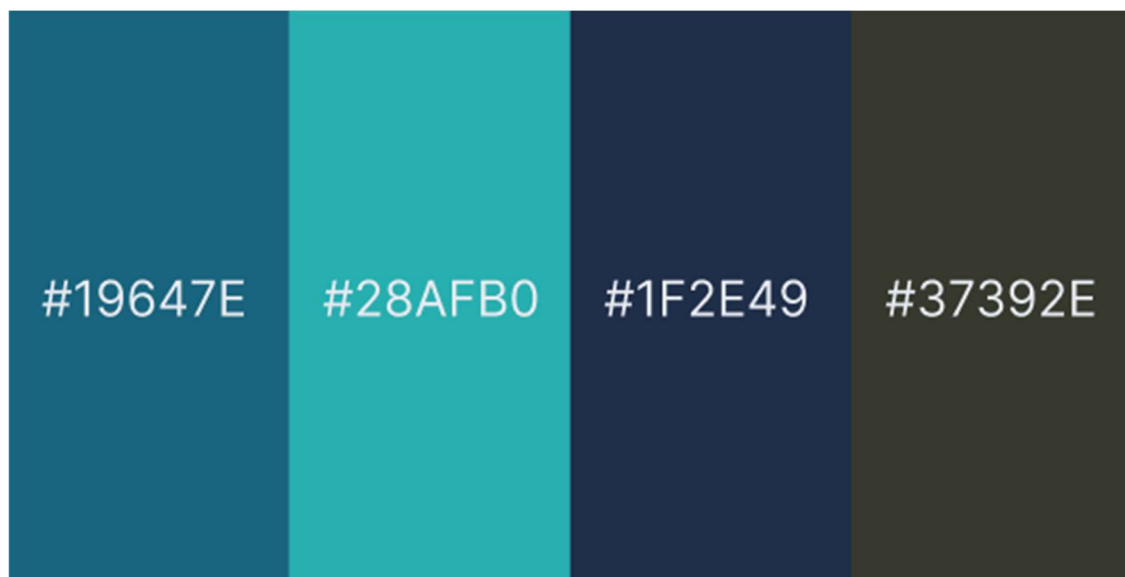
For any sensitive actions that can be taken by the user, I am always providing popups for the to be able to confirm or cancel their actions, in this way it aims to prevents accidents from happening and ensuring that the user clearly understand what is happening.

For instance, in the articles page, when viewed by the journalist, when clicking on the delete button, a popup will be displayed, asking the user for a confirmation for the deletion.



6. Consistency and Standards

I achieve a consistency in my application by using a consistent colour scheme throughout my application. This colour scheme consists of three different shades of blue and 1 shade of dark grey, in addition to the use of black and white.



In addition to this, I try to maintain consistency by maintaining similar designs for different types of uses, for instance all buttons with a written text maintain the same design in the application, in addition to this also the tables used in the web application for managing content are the same for different types of tasks. This means that the user can familiarize themselves with the UX and UI of the app, which is consistent throughout, making it easier for the user to use the app.

Table 1 – Manage Journalists

AccountNotificationsJournalistsApproval Requests

Good morning, Admin

Add New Journalist

All Journalists

Profile Picture	Full Name	Username	Email	Date of Birth	Department	Actions
	John Doe	J.Doe	j.doe@news.nl	1995-05-01	Newsroom	
	Jane Doe	Jane.Doe	jane.doe@news.nl	2000-09-07	Online	

Table 2 – Articles

AccountNotificationsJournalistsApproval Requests

Good morning, Admin

Pending Articles

Heading	Article	Last Modified	Genre	Journalist	Actions
January transfer window: Who could be on the move?	View Article	2024-01-03	Sport	John Doe	

Table 3 – Article Approval Requests

AccountNotificationsArticles

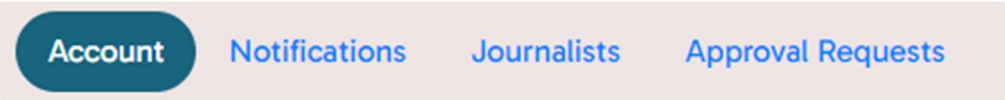
Good morning, J.Doe

Create New Article

My Articles

Heading	Article	Publish Date	Genre	Status	Actions
Experience San Francisco's six-best architectural gems	View Article	2023-12-30	Travel	Approved	
Chelsea 4-4 Manchester City: Premier League at its best? A game too good to have a winner?	View Article	2023-11-13	Breaking News	Approved	
The Isle of Elgg: The community-owned island that powers itself	View Article	2023-12-06	Travel	Approved	
US Republican Senator Tim Scott pulls out of presidential campaign	View Article	2023-12-26	Breaking News	Approved	
Giorgia Meloni visits the Job&Orienta Fair	View Article	2023-12-30	Breaking News	Approved	

7. Recognition rather than recall



In this example, when journalists are navigating through the possible actions they can take, they can easily recognize the actions that they can take by looking at the secondary account navigation bar, opposed to having to remember links, making it easy to navigate through various pages.

8. Flexibility and Efficiency of use

Efficiency of use is achieved through easy-to-use navigation throughout the app, the app consists of a head in which the user can easily navigate through the various types of genres for which articles are available, this makes it easy for the user to both visualize and select a genre of articles at any point, a sticky header has been used to achieve this which means that the header will be displayed in the application at all times.

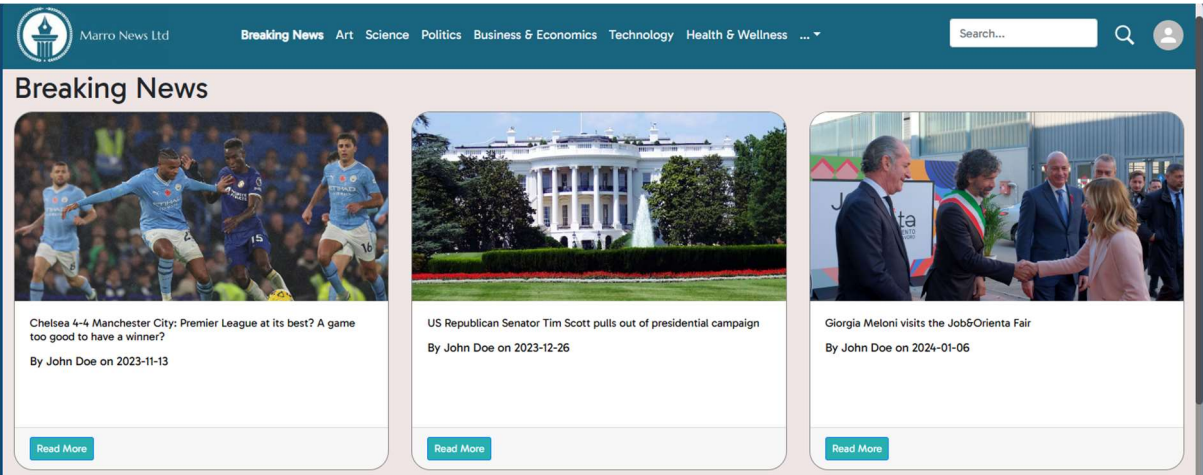
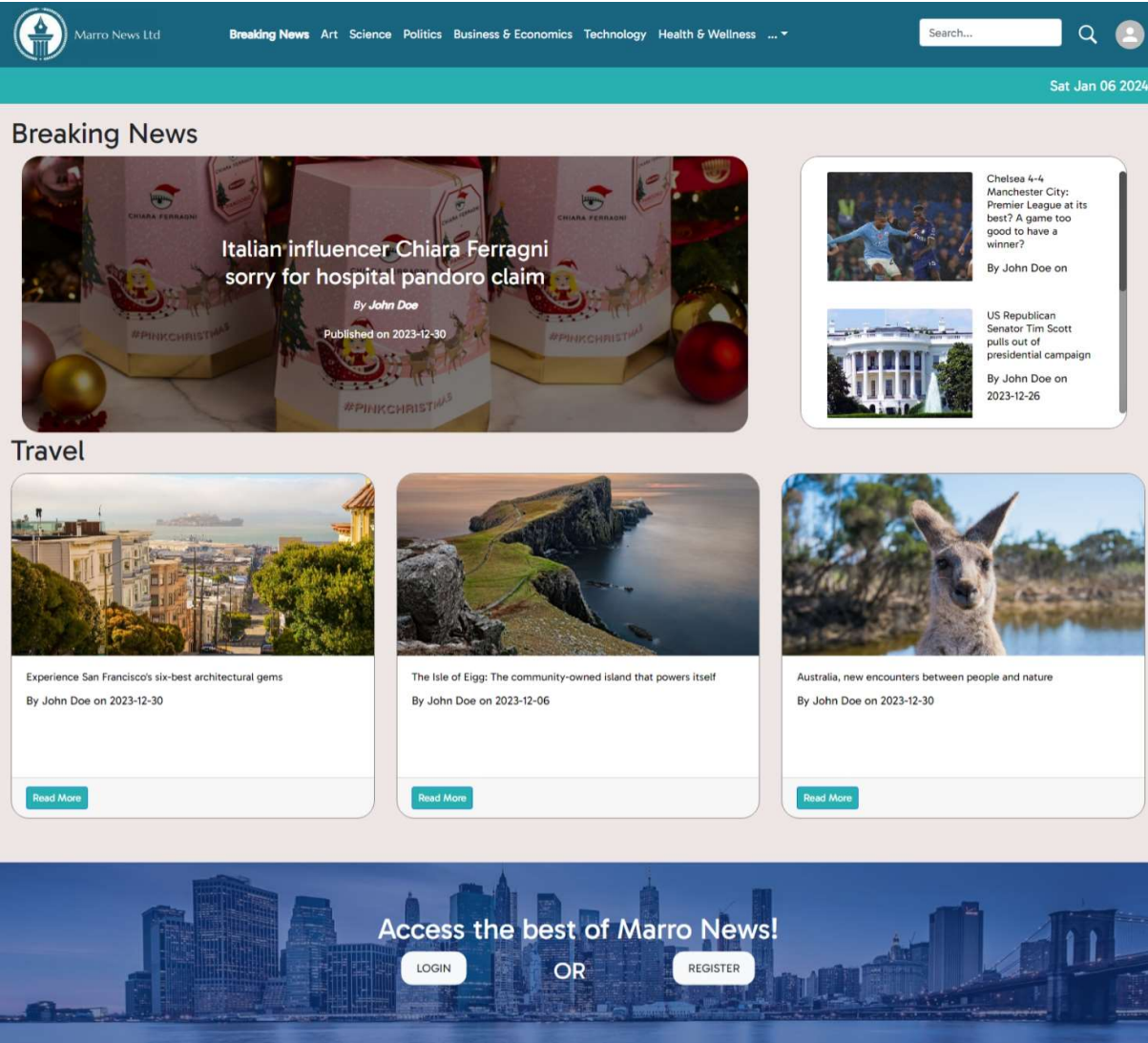


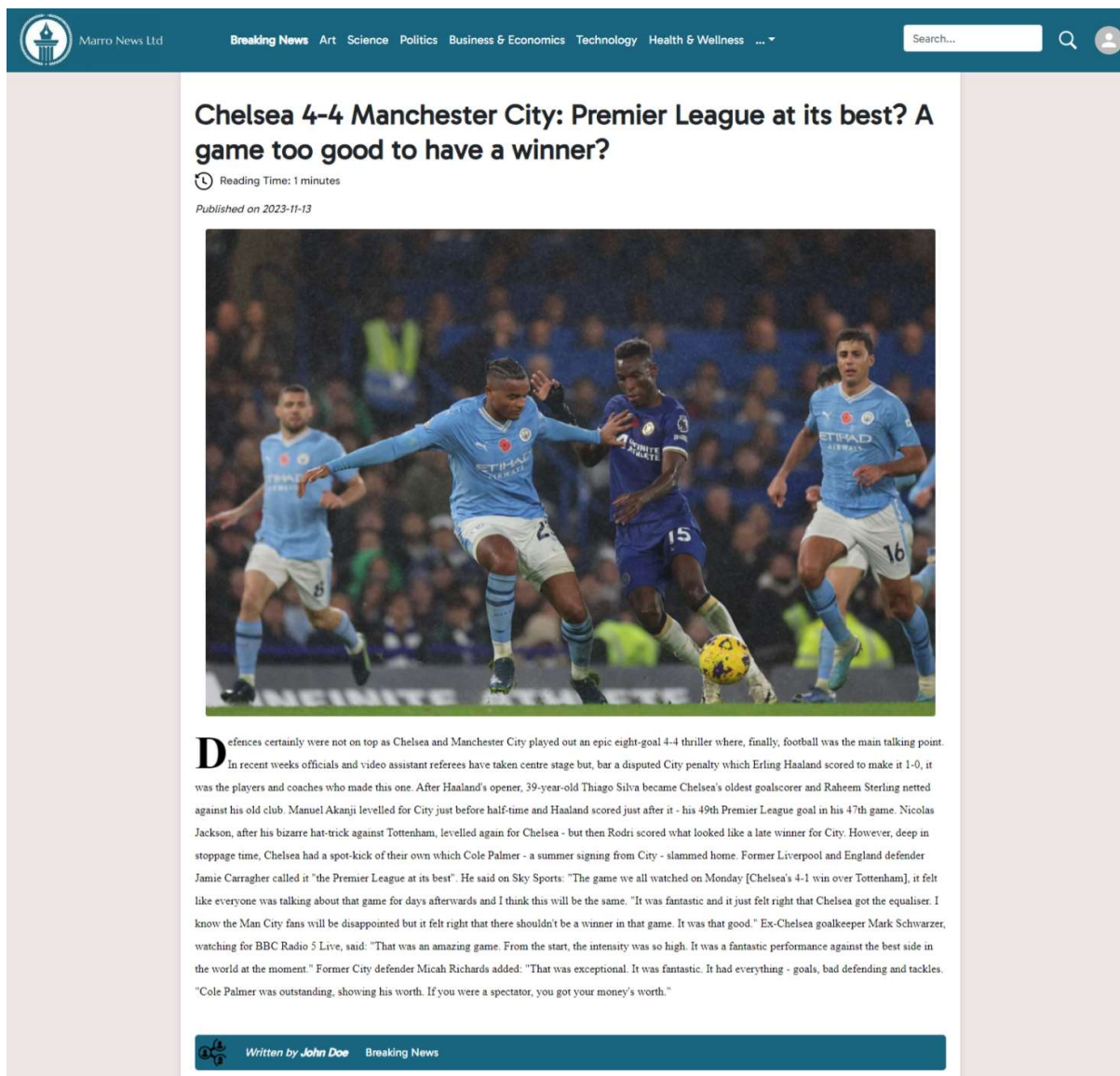
9. Aesthetic and Minimal Design

I tried to achieve an aesthetic design by initially researching news websites, and then implementing something similar yet I aimed to make it more simplified and cleaner. I made a cleaner and less-cluttered design for a news web app. An example of how I achieved this is my home page is by creating a structure of containers for the articles, thus placing the most important articles (for Breaking News) in the largest and most visible container, whereas placing other articles by genre in identical cards.

I have also added some more aesthetic touches to the app by adding some effects, such as the use of hover effects for images as well as the use of clean popups opposed to using a large number of pages for each feature.

The design is quite minimal, yet I still wanted to keep a traditional look in the app, as I wanted to make it look like a real news web app, in which many of these try to maintain an old-fashion look to resemble their original branding and the concept of an actual newspaper. This can be seen in some fonts, such as the font for the article text, including the design in which the first letter of the article is larger for the rest, as well as the old-fashioned logo of Marro News.





10. Help and Documentation

Generally, Marro News is quite an intuitive web application to use, however there are some things which may not be so straightforward to a user, an example of this is how to embed a YouTube video to an article. Just having a plain textbox to do this may easily overwhelm a user, thus I have implemented a button with a question mark icon next to this textbox, thus if the user is unsure regarding how to insert a video link, they can simply click on this button, and an overlay will appear to the side, explaining the step-by-step process for inserting the video.

Other than this, I have not created a manual for the application, however, I believe that this is not strictly necessary due to the sufficient level of the UX of the app.

ty of

Video Link Information

Here are the steps that you need to follow to successfully embed a YouTube video:

1. Go to YouTube (www.youtube.com) and click on the video that you wish to insert
2. Go to embed, locate the embed video link and copy it onto the text box on this form

Feedback for UX

I have collected some feedback from people of various backgrounds and age-groups. I collected some feedback from the group-project lesson in my group for the cultural awareness and some from some of my family members, to ensure that the app could also be considered as usable by non-ICT students.

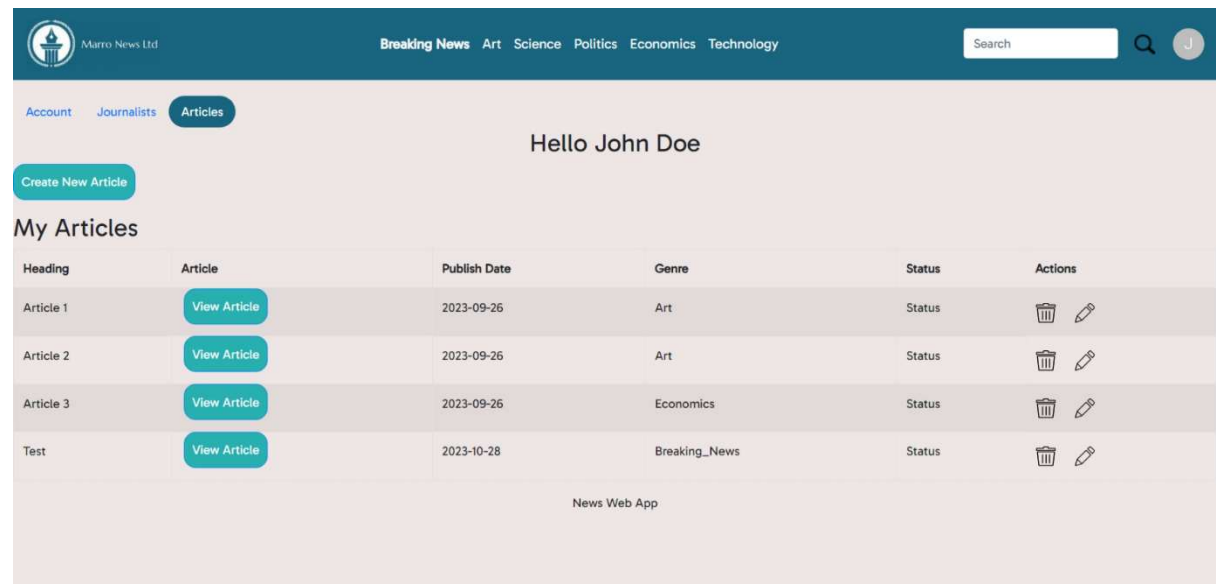
All the people that gave me feedback said that Marro News is easy and intuitive to use, and liked the UI part and said that Marro News consists of the layout of a real news web app. They pointed out some improvements which I could take into consideration:

- Being able to favourite an article directly from the card without needing to click on 'Read More'.
- Make mini nav-bar for accounts sticky.
- Approval status for articles should have a yellow background colour opposed to orange as this is more visible.
- Add margin between the contents and the frame of the website.
- Users should not be able to login to an account again unless they have been logged out.
- Use Rich Text Box for Article text to be typed in.
- Add global notification popup in the application.

For those of these points in which a visual (static) representation can be shown, I have included some of the before and after results:

1. Add margin between the contents of the frame of the website:

Before:



After:



2. Approval status for articles should have a yellow background colour opposed to orange as this is more visible.

Before and After:

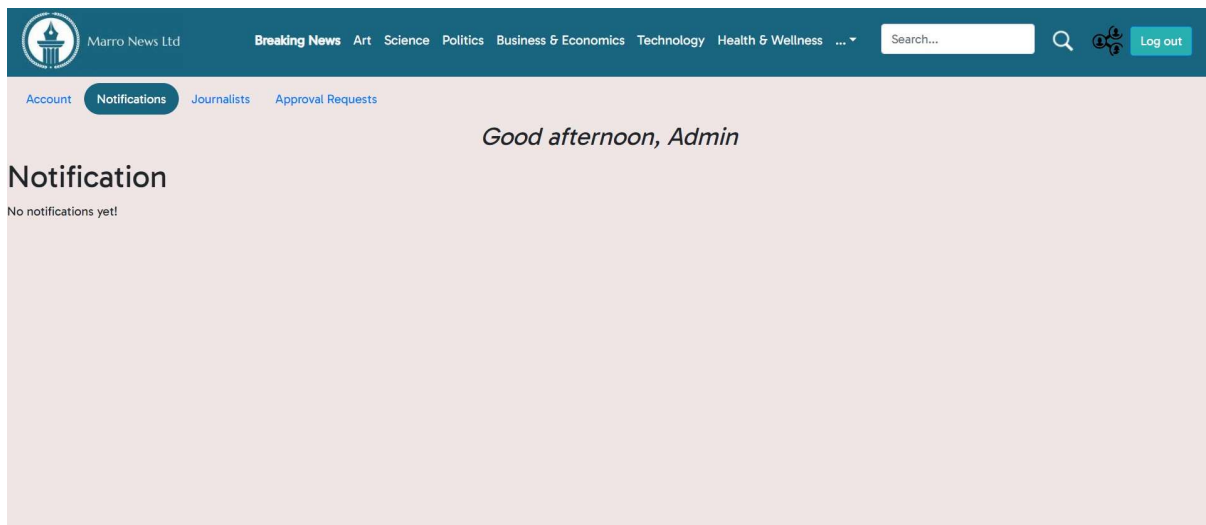


Previously, the Pending button was too similar to the Disapproved button and made it very difficult to differentiate them visually.

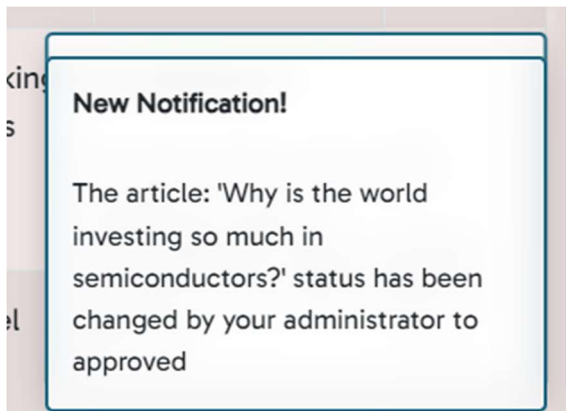
Giorgia Meloni visits the Job&Orienta Fair	View Article	2023-12-06	Breaking News	Approved	 
Waqra Pukará: Peru's mysterious 'horned fortress'	View Article	2024-01-15	Travel	Approved	 
Why is the world investing so much in semiconductors?	View Article	2024-01-18	Breaking News	Pending	 

3. Add global notification popup in the application.

Before:



After:



I have evaluated the usefulness of each point, and its general impact on not only the usability of the app, but also in terms of other aspects, such as the security risks involved, and thus priorities the most important fixes, and have implemented the majority of these in my application, some points I did not manage to complete due to the time constraints.

Conclusion

Overall, I believe that this report concludes that the UX of Marro News is quite good in terms of a small news web app made as an individual project for my studies, of course, if this were for a real news web application, many more factors would need to be considered for making the application as user-friendly as possible. Such factors could include the target age of the application, which would require extensive market research to take place, also other factors like cross-platform compatibility and responsiveness, which is not a major concern for my project, but would need to carefully be considered by a real news company to ensure that the application is easily and efficiently accessible when using different devices with different operating systems and browsers. Due to this, a real news company would also have much longer and more extensive UX reports.